

CHINMAY LOHANI

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

2020 - 2026 (*expected*)

PhD, Economics (3.94/4.00)

Courses: Topics in Industrial Organisation, Topics in Applied Microeconomics, Development Economics, Topics in Learning Theory, Advanced Econometrics, Bandits, Reinforcement Learning and Transfer Learning.

London School of Economics and Political Science

2017- 2018

Master of Science, Econometrics and Mathematical Economics (Distinction) (Inlaks Scholar 2017-18)

Courses: Adv. Microeconomics, Adv. Macroeconomics, Econometric Analysis, Contracts & Organisation.

Indian Institute of Science

2013 - 2017

Bachelor of Science (Research), Mathematics (First Class 6.6/8.0) (KVPY Scholar 2013-17)

Courses: PhD-Level: Measure Theory, Topology, Commutative Algebra & Galois theory, Complex Analysis, Approximation algorithms, Game Theory and Mechanism Design.

REFERENCES

Prof. Aviv Nevo, George A. Weiss and Lydia Bravo Weiss Professor, Wharton and UPenn Economics

Prof. Ulrich Doraszelski, Department Chair/Joseph J. Aresty Professor, Wharton and UPenn Economics

Prof. Juan Camilo Castillo, Assistant Professor, UPenn Economics

ONGOING RESEARCH PROJECTS

Financing Competition: Evidence from SBA Loans

with Maggie Isaacson (UPenn) (Invited as FRB Summer Dissertation Fellow)

Using the universe of SBA 7(a) loans, scraped hotels data for 2000+ U.S. cities, and linked firm-level data to understand the welfare implications of government subsidized credit to service markets.

Reliability and Pricing in Cloud Computing

with James Brand (Microsoft), Juan Camilo Castillo (UPenn) and Leon Musolff (Wharton)

Evaluating the pricing and market design in a cloud computing market with congestion externalities.

Labour Market Frictions, the Organization of Labor, and Structural Change

with Ananya Kotia (LSE) and Utkarsh Saxena (Oxford) (Supported by CEPR-STEG SRG Grant)

Using newly digitized firm-level panel data and quasi-experimental variation to model structural changes of labour force, firm dynamics and aggregate growth in India.

Advertisements as Entry Barriers in Consumer Goods

with Eliana Sena (UPenn)

Using individual scanner and ad exposure data to identify the crowd-out of new products due to advertisements by incumbents.

Optimal Recommendation Systems in Monopolist Platforms

with Jaume Vives-i-Bastida (Stanford)

Modelling a monopolist platform selling non-durable goods with recommendations and deriving design rules for pricing and recommendation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, Microsoft Research

Jun 2022 - Aug 2022

Worked with James Brand

Undisclosed research on empirical market design. Re-designed internal code architecture to enable high resolution data retrieval for research.

Predoctoral Fellow, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago

Aug 2018 - Aug 2020

Worked as a full time research assistant with Prof. Fiona Burlig.

Managed large datasets; used various research designs (e.g. event study, IV, RDD) to carry out data analysis; created inputs for papers & presentations. Helped design RCT with information treatments, oversaw survey logistics, and presented research to the Government of India & private stakeholders.

Intern, Center for Study of Science, Technology, Energy & Policy (C-STEP)*Jun 2017 - Aug 2017*

Conducted literature review on designing scalable systems for predicting future water demand in agriculture.

Prepared large database for prediction exercises and validated models on this data.

Drafted a memo for the State Government of Karnataka.

Research Assistant, Learning Theory Lab, Indian Institute of Science*May 2014 - Apr 2015*

Advised by Prof. Shivani Agarwal

Studied workhorse Machine Learning methods with a focus on supervised learning: Bayesian Classifier, GMMs,

Hidden Markov Models and foundations of Statistical Learning Theory.

AWARDS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

UPenn PhD Research Grant (x 2)*2023-24, 2024-25*

Granted for data collection on hotel industry in US cities.

CEPR-STEG SRG Research Grant (\$18,000)*2022-23*

Granted for the data digitization and data build for project on change of the structure of labor in India.

UPenn University Fellowship*2020-25*

Full funding to pursue a PhD in Economics.

Inlaks Foundation Graduate Scholarship (£39,000)*2017-18*

Competitive (~ 10 per year across India) full-ride scholarship to study for a Master's degree abroad.

KVPY (Young Scientist) Fellowship*2012-17*

Full-ride scholarship for high school, undergraduate studies & research awarded by the Government of India after qualifying through a competitive exam and an interview.

INSPIRE Fellowship (Declined)*2013-17*

Full-ride college award from the Government of India for securing top 0.1% nationally in high school.

Indian National Chemistry Olympiad (Declined)*2013*

Top 1% merit nationally, qualified for the national stage of the International Chemistry Olympiad.

TEACHING

Econ 002 Introduction to Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) at UPenn

Fall 2023, Spring 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Econ 705 Introduction to Econometrics (Graduate) at UPenn

Fall 2021

RA Boot Camp Advanced Stata, Spatial data in R at UChicago

*Aug 2019, 2020***CONFERENCES**

Federal Statistical Research Data Center Conference, Cornell (Presenter)

September 2025

International Industrial Organization Conference

April 2025

Johns Hopkins-NYU-UPenn Applied Microeconomics Conference (Presenter)

Oct 2024

Dynamic Structural Econometrics Summer School and Conference

*Aug 2024***SERVICE**

Graduate Economics Society, UPenn

2022-23

Industrial Organization Lunch Seminar, UPenn

*2023-24***TECHNICAL SKILLS**

Advanced: Julia, R, Stata

Intermediate: Python, MATLAB, ArcGIS, Java, C++, Spark